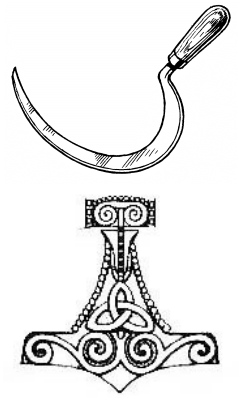


DER WALPURGISNACHTSEGE

28. OSCHDRET, 2013



ZUFIEGE ZUM JOE MAREK UN ZUM BRIAN WEIS
REV - 0 - 2012

Intonation of the Runes

Each rune is intoned thrice: Hagalaz, Kenaz, Jera, Wunjo

Die Heiliching

*Sichel, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell
Beschitzt uns mit der Graft vun de Ziewe
Bei Wudan un Frigg fer der Gemeeschaft zu baue
Bei Ziu un Zisa fer die Gerechdichkeet un der Fruchsfriede zu erhalde
Bei Ing un Freya fer die Wohldaat zu schneide un zu sammle
Bei Dunner un Siwwa fer es Volk vollzumechtiche.
Bei der Fraa Holle fer es Volk zu erneire
Wie schmittet der Hammer die Sichel,
So die Sichel der Hammer fiedert.
'S iss es Lewesraad, zu saehe un zu schneide
Sichel, heilich daer Aldaar un die Schtell!*

Heel!

Heel!

Heel!

Unser Zweck - Our Purpose

Heit sammle mir uns do, fer unser Haerrinn Holle zu ehre.

Unseri Haerrin Holle iss die mild, doch mehdich, Beschitzerin vum Pennsilfaanisch Deitsch Volk. Mit der Weisheet, der Gnaad, un em Mitleid fiehrt die Holle uns darrich de Leweszeitte.

Heit sehne mir, as es Land bei ihrem Gefiehl erneirt iss.

Es Lewe schpringt ums ringsrum!

Losset uns zamme die Leweswonne feiere!

We are gathered here to honor our Lady Holle.

Holle is the mild, yet powerful, Protectoress of the Deutsch nation. With Wisdom, Grace, and Compassion, Holle guides us through the lifetimes.

Today we see that the Land is renewed by Her touch.

Life is springing all around us!

Let us celebrate the joy of life together!

Heel Holle!

Der Aaruf - The Invocation

Liewi Haerrin Holle!

Mir bidde Dich mit uns zu bsuche

Un mit uns heit die Wonne zu feiere

Sei unser verehrter Gaschtin

un unseri Freindschaft verdeelee.

Heele!

Es Opfer un Die Eed - Offerings and Oaths

Losst uns enniche Opfer uff der Aldaar adder in 's Feier yetz schtelle

Un wann ennichebber hot en Eed zu bschweere, kumm yetz vora.

If anyone has any offerings, please place them onto the altar, or, later, into the fire.

If anyone has any oaths to take, come forward now.

Die Heiliching vun de Opfer - Hallowing of the Offerings

Zu Dir, Liewi Haerrin Holle

Mir hewwe die Seidel aa

Mir biede Seider aa

Un gewwe die do annere Gschenker

Wie 'n Zeichnis zu unserer Dankbaardeet

un vun unserer Gemeeschaft

Darrich Dich binne mir uns fescht aa

Losst 's immer so sei!

Heel Holle!

Heel zu de Ziewe!

Heel zu de Vorgenger!

Heel zu de Noochkummer!

Heel die Gemeeschaft!

Hail Holle!

Hail to the deities!

Hail to the ancestors!

Hail to the descendants!

Hail to the community!

Die Ausdeeling - The Distribution

Der Sege - The Blessing

When pouring the libations, all say (choose either language):

*Vun de Ziewe zu der Erd zu uns
Vun uns zu der Erd zu de Gedder*

*From the gods to the Earth to us
From us to the Earth to the gods*

*'N Gschenk fer 'n Gschenk
Heele!*

*A gift for a gift.
Hail!*

Zum Schluss - In Closing

*Heit beginne mir en neis Wonefescht
un baue do en sctandhafliches Bindnis zamme
Mit de Ziewe
Un darrich unserer allgemee Zweck
Losst uns zamme immer sctarricker waxe.*

*Today we begin a new festival of joy
and build here a steadfast alliance together
with the Deities
And through our common purpose
Let us all grow stronger together.*

Der Sege iss beschlosse waerre.

This Sege is closed.

Zu de Wichde - To The Wights

*Mir gewwe aa en Opfer zu de Wichde
Vun desem Land
Un mir bedanke uns 'ne
Fer ihrer Schirm*

*We give also an offering to the Wights
of this Land
And we are thankful to them
For their protection*

Heel!

Hail!

Discussion Topics

- Along with Yuul, this is the highest holiday on the Urglaawe calendar.
- Significance comes to us through Heathen lore and through Braucherei lore.
- The night of April 30 into May 1 is observance of the return of Holle from the Furious Host (Wild Hunt) that began on Allelieweziel (31. Gehling/October) to the soil. Her return brings the land to back to full life.
- Holle is a member of the Wane (Vanir) tribe of the deities. *Teutonic Mythology* indicates Her consort as Holler, who may be Ewicher Yeeger seen in Deitsch lore.
- There is a distinct relationship between the return of Holle and the May Day celebrations of fertility.
- Holle is a well-known and proactive deity within Urglaawe and Braucherei. She plays an active role in the birth-life-death-rebirth cycle, including protecting the souls of the deceased until they are ready for the next life.
- Time-cord work in Braucherei uses imagery of Holle putting souls through Her mill to prepare for the rebirth of the parts of the soul that are reborn. The soul is seen to have twelve parts, at least one of which is reborn into a subsequent generations. Some say that this is why people feel sometimes like a new acquaintance is so familiar.
- Walburga is another name for Holle or Bercha. In some parts of Germany, this is a night to dress in costume and burn effigies of witches (a Christian image). We, of course, view this differently and it is not a matter of evil but of spirituality. Many events related to the Furious Host involve costumes (Halloween, King Frost, Belsnickel, Mummers, Mardis Gras, and perhaps even the roots of the April Fool. Did you ever notice how all these costume events disappear after the end of April? They all represent the parade of spirits that is now over.
- In Deitsch lore, on April 30 and May 1, people open all their doors and their windows to the home and hang a sign over the doorway. The sign reads, "WALBURGA" or "HOLLE" and welcomes Holle into the home.
- The fairy tale of Holle indicates that She likes an orderly, clean home. The concept of "spring cleaning," at least among the Deitsch, has its origins in the time of preparation for Her arrival. Spring cleaning is initiated at Grundsaudaag with the cleaning of the hearth and is to be concluded by Walpurgisnacht. Brauchers move items out of halls and remove clutter from the path at this time (alas, I am remiss in this effort, though I keep trying!).
- It is safe to put frost-hardy plants into the ground, but Deitsch lore says that frost-sensitive plants should wait until the daytime of May 15. Three Frost Giants pass through on May 13, 14, and 15 (See "Twelve Nights of the Wonnetdanz" below).
- The lore gives these frost giants' names as Dreizehdax ("thirteen badger", Vatzehvedder ("fourteen quill" (porcupine)), and Fuffzehfux ("fifteen fox").

Seasonal Focus

Walpurgisnacht to Midsummer: Experience the joy of life, including the joy of planting new life in the ground. Make the planting a spiritual, loving event. Revel in friends, family, kindred, hobbies, and things you enjoy. Moifescht (May Day) is also the observance of male creative energies.

Keep in mind that days in Urglaawe practice begin at sundown. Thus, sundown on Tuesday, April 30 (Dinschdaag, 30. Broochet), is actually the beginning of Wednesday, May 1 (Wudanschdaag (Mittwoch), 1. Wonnet).

Second New Moon after Oschdre = Holzent Neimuun (Wood Duck New Moon) on the traditional Deutsch lunar calendar. The Holzent Muunet (Wood Duck Month) begins this year on May 10 and ends on June 8.

The Wood Duck Moon begins with the second new moon after the end of winter. This moon sign is associated with adaptability and unification. These aspects are represented in the Wood Duck's equal comfort in the air, in the water, or in the brush. Deutsch lunar lore indicates that those born under the Wood Duck moon seek to create security in the world around them. Despite the emergence of Spring, in the natural world, food is still scarce at this time, but the abundance of Summer will soon overwhelm us.

The unifier aspect of Wood Duck is also reflected in the capricious weather at this time of year, which can still fluctuate from Summer to Winter temperatures in a matter of hours. The heat and the ice can still be found easily as part of the daily routine. This year, however, the Wood Duck moon falls later than usual, so the likelihood of the icy temperatures diminishes within the first week of the lunar cycle.

Mitleid - This is the virtue of Compassion. The concept is different from the modern era understanding of this word, however. The focus of Mitleid is that of an appropriate compassion for others who are in a position through no fault of their own or who have seen their errors and are attempting to correct them. Compassion for irresponsibility is detrimental to the whole of the community. However, equally detrimental is providing no path to redemption for those who are trying to straighten themselves out. They become stuck in a quagmire of their mistakes, even if they are striving to distance themselves from their prior behavior.

In some cases, the compassion is towards those who have experienced a loss or a tragedy. This may include a loss of employment or losses incurred in a natural disaster, etc. Each year, Urglaawe organizations hold a food drive at Erntfescht. Filling the local food banks can help the wider community. These are gifts in exchange for the gifts we have in our lives. They are voluntary and free of compulsion. Also, we never know whether we may be in need of such assistance ourselves someday.

We should take careful consideration of the errors or crimes and the efforts the individual is taking to correct his/her ways. Mitleid can result in our lending a hand, when feasible in order to help strengthen our community overall.

The folk tale of *Frau Holle* provides some insight into the Germanic understanding of the importance of Mitleid. The mistreated stepdaughter falls into a well and awakens in Holle's meadow. The girl encounters some bread that is baking in an oven and will soon burn if not removed.

The girl dutifully removes the bread. She then encounters an apple tree, the branches of which are heavy with apples. The girl shakes the tree to lighten its load. Holle rewards these compassionate acts, along with other virtuous behavior, by covering the girl in gold before sending her back to her family. Conversely, her lazy stepsister, who lacks virtue consistently throughout the tale, is covered in pitch.

Verwandschaft: The virtue of Kinship reflects the need that all of us have to belong to a community. Despite the efforts of the consumer culture to separate and divide people in order to increase corporate bottom lines, it is unnatural for humans not to live and to exist in a social setting. Kinship, along with other virtues, can help to create an environment of security, trust, and interdependence among the members of a community. Even while we embrace Self-Reliance (*Selbschtzuverdraue*), we also embrace that community interdependence, which is reflected in the Heathen concepts of gift exchanges and frith.

Twelve Nights of the Wonnetdanz

Every now and again, I come across short references that help to fill in some gaps in the understanding of our traditional practices.

One such gap is the time between Walpurgisnacht and the arrival of the Reifries (Frost Giants) thirteen days later. I think we finally have an answer.

On our current calendar, Walpurgisnacht falls on the night of April 30. However, since Urglaawe days begin at sundown, that night is actually 1. Wonnet (May 1) on the Urglaawe calendar. Deitsch tradition is that the Witches' Dances (Urglaawe: "die Wonnetdanz," which translates to the "the dances of joy") take place at a variety of locations across the Deitscherei. Primary among these sites is Hexenkopf, which is located in Williams Township in Northampton County, but there are other sites as well.

In Germany, similar traditions relate to the Brocken, also known as Blocksberg, in the Harz Mountains. While I cannot speak to the exact meaning of the traditions at the Brocken, the impetus for the celebration in Deitsch culture is the return of Holle to the Hatzholz (also known as Mannheim, Midgard, or the physical realm). Hexenkopf is said to be Her home in this land. Her return brings order to the land and begins the growing season.

Tradition also holds that the Frost Giants become aware of Holle's return and attempt to destroy the order by freezing the land. Different Braucherei guilds have variations of this story, but the most cohesive version states that the first Frost Giant, Dreizehdax, arrives on the night of May 12 into May 13, which is actually 13. Wonnet on the Urglaawe calendar. Dreizehdax's efforts are thwarted by Dunner, and the Frost Giant is forced to retreat.

On the next night (May 13 into May 14), another Frost Giant, Vatzehvedder, makes his attempt. On that night, Dunner provides instruction to all of the Butzemenner (activated scarecrows) across the countryside in how to stop the Frost Giant. Vatzehvedder is also forced to retreat. On the third night (May 14 into May 15), Fuffzehfux makes his attempt and is beaten back by the combined efforts of the Butzemenner. After the pass of Fuffzehfux, it is considered safe to plant all crops outdoors.

I have often wondered about a few things regarding the variations of this story. For starters, there

are so many locations where Witches' Dances and Wonnetdanz were said to take place. Also, I wondered about the gap between the celebration of 1. Wonnet and the battle with Dreizehdax on 13. Wonnet.

Both situations can be explained by a small reference on p. 1619 of Volume IV of Grimm's *Teutonic Mythology*: "The Witches' Excursion takes place on the first night in May"... "They ride up Blocksberg on the first of May, and in 12 days must dance the snow away; then Spring begins."

This implies that the Wonnetdanz is a multiple night occasion, perhaps symbolically beginning in the lowlands and working its way up the hills into the mountains. In our case, it would begin in places like Hexefeld near Riemescheddel in the lowlands, up through Hexebaerrick in Berks County, and ending at Hexenkopf.

Although many Urglaawer have already been observing the Wonnetdanz for several days after Walpurgisnacht, the reference in *Teutonic Mythology* provides some insight as to the likely cause of the delay between the restoration of order to the land and the Frost Giants' efforts to undo Holle's work. Henceforth, Distelfink Sippschaft will recognize the Wonnetdanz will be a twelve-night celebration in a manner similar to the Yuulzeit.

For Reference

The Heathen Nine Noble Virtues (Die Nein Edelreenheide):

der Mut: Courage

die Waahrheit: Truth

Honor: die Ehr

Fidelity/Troth: die Treie

Discipline: die Addning

Hospitality: die Uffwaarting

Self-Reliance: es Selbschtzuverdraue

Industriousness: die Schaffichheit

Perseverance/Steadfastness: die Ausdauer

Implied among these, but more directly state in Urglaawe, are ancillary virtues called Newwereenheide:

Wisdom: die Weisheit

Introspection: der Selbschtreiguck

Kinship: die Verwandschaft

Generosity: der Edelmut

Curiosity: die Neigierheit

Compassion: es Mitleid

Self-Improvement: die Selbschtverbessering

Stewardship: die Verwalting

Spirituality: die Geischtlichkeet